



DVD Writers

Dual Layer DVD Writer Pioneer DVR-108

Spec: 16X DVD+R, 16X DVD-R, 4X DVD+RW, 4X DVD-RW, 2.4X DVD+R DL, 32X CD-R and 24X CD-RW

Our Verdict: The Pioneer DVR-108 was the best Dual layer DVD writer that we have seen this year. The drive is feature-packed and outplays most others except the one from Asus. The DVR-108 supports over-burning and can hence write DVDs above



the supported speed. On the performance front, it burns a Dual layer DVD in under 27 minutes; faster than most writers. Reasonably priced, the Pioneer DVR-108 is the best DVD writer that money can buy.

Runner up
Asus DRW-1604P

External Hard Drives

Portable Hard Drives

Western Digital Media Centre 250 GB

Specs: 7200 RPM, 8 MB buffer, average latency 4.2ms, 8-in-1 memory card reader, Firewire and USB 2.0 interface

Our Verdict: The integrated 8-in-1 memory card reader, 8 MB buffer and the dual interface makes the Media Centre a unique product in its own right. This is the best external hard drive that you can bet your money on.



Runner-up: **Maxtor One Touch 250GB**

Compact Hard Drives

Freecom FDH-2 PRO 80 GB

Specs: 1.8-inch platter, 175 gms, 2 MB buffer and USB 2.0 interface

Our Verdict: With the lowest per-MB price, one-touch button for backup, excellent looks and stable performance, it took our 'Best Buy' Gold award in this category of hard drives.

Runner-up:

Transcend StoreJet TS0GSJ25



Gaming Devices

Game Pads

Logitech Cordless RumblePad

Specs: Cordless, rumble effects, D-pad, 11 programmable buttons, two analogue controller sticks and a slider throttle.

Our Verdict: This is, by far, the definitive game pad. If "only the best" is your *mantra*, look no further than Logitech's Cordless Rumble Pad. This game pad combines the best of all worlds, and packs in features that justify its high price. The analogue sticks are sensitive and offer right amount of feed-

back to the smallest nudge. The perfectly laid out buttons offer long hours of stress free play. Since the pad uses the 2.4 GHz radio frequency for cordless operation, the controller can be used from as far as 20 feet away. The controller requires four AA batteries, which makes it quite heavy. The driver software is simple to use and buttons can be programmed according to your choice.

Runner-up: **Logitech Precision USB**



Flashback To December 2000

Iomega 2 GB Jaz

Specs: SCSI Drive

Evolution: Four years ago, the 2 GB Jaz drive was the "in" thing. Today, an 80 GB ultra-compact hard drive is it. **Comparing sizes:** you can make out the obvious difference—the ultra-compact drive is much smaller than the Jaz drive. The 2 GB Jaz was priced at Rs 21,000 back then, so is the Freecom FDH-2 PRO 80 GB. Effectively, the price per MB has dropped 40 times.

Gaming Device

Evolution: Over the four years since 2000, the basic technology powering gaming devices hasn't seen many advances, except for some striking designs and low price tags. Game pads were considered to be quite versatile and they are still preferred for the different types of inputs they provide, such as analogue sticks and D-pad. Initial game pads were simple devices, but today, they pack in some real stuff such as rumble effects, cordless operation, programmable keys etc.

